

Gut Health Quiz

Symptom quiz, food lists, the 30-plants tally and a 7-day digestion journal · Module 2, Training 4

Why the gut matters for conception

About 70% of immune cells live in and around the gut (Vighi et al., *Clinical & Experimental Immunology*); gut bacteria recycle estrogen via the "estrobolome" (Baker et al., *Maturitas*); fermented foods increased microbiome diversity and lowered 19 inflammatory markers within 10 weeks (Wastyk et al., *Cell*, 2021); and gut microbes influence mood and appetite through the gut-brain axis (Cryan & Dinan, *Nature Reviews Neuroscience*).

Part 1 · Symptom quiz (take it before you change anything; 40 XP with the food add)

For the last month: 0 = never · 1 = sometimes · 2 = often · 3 = most days

#	SYMPTOM	0	1	2	3
1	Bloating or a distended belly after meals	☐	☐	☐	☐
2	Bowel movements slower than once a day, or straining	☐	☐	☐	☐
3	Loose or urgent bowel movements	☐	☐	☐	☐
4	Reflux, heartburn or burping	☐	☐	☐	☐
5	Strong sugar or refined-carbohydrate cravings	☐	☐	☐	☐
6	Tiredness or fog within an hour of eating	☐	☐	☐	☐
7	Skin flare-ups (acne, eczema, rashes)	☐	☐	☐	☐
8	Frequent colds or slow recovery	☐	☐	☐	☐
9	Gas that is frequent or uncomfortable	☐	☐	☐	☐
10	Low mood or irritability that tracks with digestion	☐	☐	☐	☐
11	Antibiotic courses in the last year (0 = none, 1 = one, 2 = two, 3 = three+)	☐	☐	☐	☐
12	Fewer than 15 different plant foods in a typical week	☐	☐	☐	☐

Total: ____ / 36. 0–8 = *settled* (maintain: variety and one fermented food) · 9–18 = *unsettled* (this module's practice will likely help; track for two weeks) · 19–36 = *strained* (do the practice **and** book a conversation with your doctor).

Not a diagnosis. See your doctor promptly for: blood in stool, unexplained weight loss, severe or persistent pain, symptoms that are worsening, or a family history of bowel disease or celiac disease.

Part 2 · Foods that heal

GROUP	ADD THESE	NOTES
Probiotic (live cultures)	plain full-fat yogurt & kefir ("live cultures" on label) · refrigerated sauerkraut & kimchi · miso · tempeh · kombucha (small amounts)	Start with 1 tbsp sauerkraut or ¼ cup kefir daily; build up over two weeks. Shelf-stable pickles are usually pasteurised (no live cultures).
Prebiotic (fiber that feeds bacteria)	onions, garlic, leeks, asparagus, slightly green bananas, oats, apples, beans, lentils, chicory, Jerusalem artichoke	Target 25–30 g fiber/day; 1 cup lentils ≈ 15 g. Increase gradually with plenty of water.
Polyphenol (colour)	berries, extra-virgin olive oil, green tea, dark chocolate, red onion, herbs and spices, the vegetable rainbow	Already on your fertility list.

Ease off: ultra-processed foods, alcohol, very high sugar intake. **Also helps:** sleep, movement, stress management (Modules 3 and 4).

Probiotic supplements: evidence is strain-specific; food first. Ask your doctor or a registered dietitian about strain and dose, especially after antibiotics.

Part 3 · The 30-plants tally

Aim for 30 different plant foods a week. Herbs, spices, nuts, seeds, beans and grains all count. Write each new one once.

1	2	3	4	5	6

This week's count: ____

Part 4 · 7-day digestion journal (30 XP)

My probiotic food this week: _____ Amount: _____

DAY	ATE IT?	BLOATING 0-3	REGULARITY (S=SLOW, N=NORMAL, F=FAST)	ENERGY AFTER MEALS 1-10	CRAVINGS 0-3	NOTES
1	☐					
2	☐					
3	☐					
4	☐					
5	☐					
6	☐					
7	☐					

End of week: direction of change ☐ better ☐ same ☐ worse · sleep hours this week (average) _____ · what I'll keep: _____

Re-take the quiz in two weeks and compare: first score _____ → second score _____.

Share tips in the forum (20 XP)

Post your favourite way to eat a fermented food, or ask for one. Someone there has never tried kefir.

Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.